

French Political and Fiscal Risk Calendar

France enters the final months of 2026 with unusually elevated fiscal and political risk. The government has reduced its 2026 growth forecast to 0.5% and acknowledged that its previous 5.0% deficit target will be missed, while debt stood at 117.5% of GDP at the end of the first quarter. The government is currently preparing a 2027 budget reportedly involving around €54 billion of savings and targeting a deficit of approximately 5% of GDP.

Date	Event	Notes
29 September 2026	INSEE Q2 public-debt release	France's public debt as defined by the Maastricht criteria reached 117.5% of GDP in Q1, up from 115.7% in Q4 2025. Another increase would reinforce concerns about the fiscal outlook immediately before the budget is presented.
30 September 2026	Preliminary September inflation	Inflation has recently accelerated because of higher energy prices; August CPI was 2.4% year-on-year. Higher inflation matters both through ECB policy and through indexed public expenditure.
1 October 2026	Presentation of the 2027 budget	The government intends to present the 2027 budget to the Council of Ministers and Parliament, including the final deficit target, spending cuts, pension measures, corporate taxation, growth assumptions and projected interest costs. The current draft reportedly seeks roughly €54 billion of savings and a 2027 deficit around 5% of GDP.
1 October 2026	Second center-left primary debate	Fiscal differences between the candidates should become increasingly clear ahead of the primary.
9–10 October 2026	First round of center-left primary	Five candidates are currently expected to compete. The contest will determine which part of the social-democratic left enters the presidential campaign.
12–19 October 2026	National Assembly debate on the revenue side of the new budget	The first major parliamentary stress test for the budget. Tax provisions, revenue assumptions and deficit-reduction measures will be debated in an Assembly where the government has no majority.
16–17 October 2026	Second round of center-left primary	If no candidate reaches an absolute majority in the first round.
20 October 2026	Scheduled Assembly vote on the first part of the new budget	Might decide whether the government can build a coalition around the fiscal side of the budget and what concessions may be required to do so.

Date	Event	Notes
20–26 October 2026	Assembly debate on the 2027 Social Security budget	Particularly important for pensions, healthcare and welfare expenditure, which represent some of the most politically difficult areas in which to achieve fiscal consolidation. An Assembly vote on the bill at first reading is scheduled for 27 October.
23 October 2026	Moody's sovereign rating review	Moody's currently rates France Aa3 with a negative outlook. Given the negative outlook, this is likely to be one of the most closely watched rating dates of the autumn, coming after the initial parliamentary debate on the budget.
27 October 2026	Social Security Funding Bill vote; spending-side budget debate begins	The Assembly votes on the Social Security budget and immediately begins detailed consideration of state expenditure under the new budget.
29 October 2026	ECB monetary-policy decision	Particularly relevant given renewed euro-area inflation pressure and the direct impact of ECB policy on French financing costs. The decision and press conference will also provide a new reference point for the OAT-Bund spread.
30 October 2026	First estimate of Q3 French GDP	One of the last major growth readings before the budget moves toward its final parliamentary stages. Weak growth would worsen the denominator effect on debt ratios and make the government's revenue and deficit assumptions harder to achieve.
10 November 2026	Q3 unemployment data	The unemployment rate reached 8.3% in Q2. Further deterioration would increase both political pressure against spending restraint and concerns over social-security expenditure.
November 2026	European Commission Autumn Economic Forecast	The Commission will update its independent assessment of French growth, deficit and debt. Its spring forecast projected public debt above 120% of GDP in 2027 under unchanged policies. The autumn forecast will be particularly important for comparing Brussels' assessment with the assumptions underpinning the new budget and France's commitments under the EU Excessive Deficit Procedure.
17 November 2026	Scheduled Assembly vote on the full budget bill at first reading	The principal parliamentary test of the government's budget.

Date	Event	Notes
17 November 2026	<i>continued</i>	Failure to secure sufficient support would push negotiations into a more uncertain phase involving the Senate, further parliamentary readings and potentially alternative constitutional procedures.
Late November–December 2026	Senate consideration and parliamentary budget endgame	Assuming the Assembly completes its first reading, the budget proceeds to the Senate and then through the parliamentary navette, that is, the back and forth between the National Assembly and the Senate, making the revisions it deems necessary. This period will determine whether France enters 2027 with an enacted budget or again requires temporary arrangements. France began 2026 under a special finance law after Parliament failed to adopt the budget before year-end.
27 November 2026	S&P sovereign rating review	S&P currently rates France A+ with a stable outlook. The decision falls after the scheduled Assembly budget vote and should therefore incorporate substantially more information about the credibility of the fiscal package.
27 November 2026	Detailed Q3 national accounts	Provides fuller information on domestic demand, investment, household income and public finances following the 30 October flash GDP estimate.
11 December 2026	KBRA sovereign rating review	KBRA currently rates France AA- with a stable outlook. This is the last currently scheduled sovereign-rating review of France in 2026.
17 December 2026	ECB monetary-policy decision	The final scheduled ECB monetary-policy meeting of 2026. Particularly relevant for the interest-rate assumptions entering 2027 and for France's rapidly increasing debt-service burden.
By 31 December 2026	2027 budget endgame	The key question is whether a full finance law is in place for the beginning of 2027. A repeat of the 2025–26 crisis would renew concerns over political capacity to implement medium-term fiscal consolidation.
4 February 2027	ECB monetary-policy decision	First scheduled ECB decision of the presidential-election year.
18 March 2027	ECB monetary-policy decision	The final scheduled ECB meeting before the first round of the French presidential election.

Date	Event	Notes
Late March 2027	INSEE full-year 2026 deficit and debt figures	Potentially one of the most important pre-election fiscal releases. The precise 2027 publication date has not yet been announced; the equivalent 2025 figures were published on 27 March 2026. The release will provide the first estimates of the 2026 deficit and year-end debt ratio only weeks before the presidential election.
By early April 2027	Expected Cour de cassation ruling in Le Pen case	The Cour de cassation has said that it may be able to rule by early April, before the presidential election. Because the proceedings concern one of the principal presidential candidates, the decision could alter the electoral field very late in the campaign. The court cautions that the timetable remains dependent on procedural developments.
18 April 2027	First round of the 2027 presidential election	If no candidate wins an absolute majority, the top two candidates advance to the second round. While Le Pen is currently expected to finish first in the first round by a large margin, the second-place candidate remains unknown.
29 April 2027	ECB monetary-policy decision	An unusually significant ECB meeting because it falls between the two rounds of the French presidential election, when French political risk could be particularly visible in euro-area bond spreads.
2 May 2027	Second round of the 2027 presidential election	France elects its next president. Attention would then move towards the parliamentary election later the same year, deciding on the president's effective abilities.